I want to create a data set for a project in my Data Analytics course to also practice my Excel skills, like creating analyses of it

Great idea—that's *exactly* how you build real data skills. Instead of just learning Excel features, you'll understand *why* you're using them.

Let's approach this like I would in a data analytics class 👇

Step 1: Pick a Project Theme (this matters a LOT)

Choose something that:

- Interests you (so you don't get bored)
- Has clear "questions" you can answer

Here are strong beginner-friendly dataset ideas:

Option A: Sales Dataset (most recommended)

Create a fake company sales dataset.

Columns:

- Order ID
- Date
- Customer Name
- Product Category (Electronics, Clothing, etc.)
- Product Name
- Quantity
- Price
- Total Revenue
- Region (Midwest, West, etc.)
- Sales Rep

👉 This is PERFECT for:

- Pivot tables

- Revenue trends
- Top products
- Regional analysis

Option B: Personal Finance Tracker

Columns:

- Date
- Expense Category (Food, Rent, Transport)
- Description
- Amount
- Payment Type (Cash, Card)

👉 Great for:

- Monthly summaries
- Budget analysis
- Category breakdowns

Option C: Fitness / Habit Tracker

Columns:

- Date
- Activity (Workout, Run, Rest)
- Duration
- Calories Burned
- Mood (1–5)

👉 Good for:

- Trend analysis
- Correlations

Option D: Student Performance Dataset

Columns:

- Student Name
- Subject

- Exam Score
- Study Hours
- Attendance %

👉 Great intro to:

- Correlation (study hours vs score)
- Averages & distributions

Step 2: Add Enough Data (IMPORTANT)

You want:

- **At least 100–300 rows**
- Mix of values (not all the same)

Tip:

- Use patterns like repeating names, categories, and dates
- You can drag-fill in Excel to scale quickly

Step 3: Questions You Should Be Able to Answer

Design your dataset so you can answer things like:

For Sales:

- Which product makes the most revenue?
- Which region performs best?
- What are monthly trends?
- Who is the top sales rep?

For Finance:

- Where do I spend the most money?
- How do expenses change over time?

👉 If your dataset can't answer questions, it's not useful yet.

Step 4: Excel Skills You'll Practice

Once your dataset is ready, you can practice:

Core Skills:

- Sorting & filtering
- Conditional formatting
- Data validation (dropdowns)

Formulas:

- `SUM`, `AVERAGE`, `IF`
- `SUMIF` / `SUMIFS`
- `COUNTIF`

Analysis Tools:

- Pivot tables (VERY important)
- Charts (bar, line, pie)
- Trend analysis

Step 5: Make It Feel Like a Real Project

Treat it like a portfolio piece:

- Give your dataset a name (e.g., “Retail Sales Analysis 2025”)
- Create a dashboard sheet
- Add charts + insights

If You Want, I Can Help You Build It

We can go one step deeper and I can:

- Generate a **ready-to-copy dataset for you**
- Or guide you step-by-step in Excel like a live instructor
- Or help you turn it into a **portfolio project**

👉 Tell me:

1. Which dataset idea you like (Sales, Finance, Fitness, etc.)
2. Your skill level in Excel (beginner / intermediate)

And I’ll build something *tailored for you* that actually helps you level up fast.